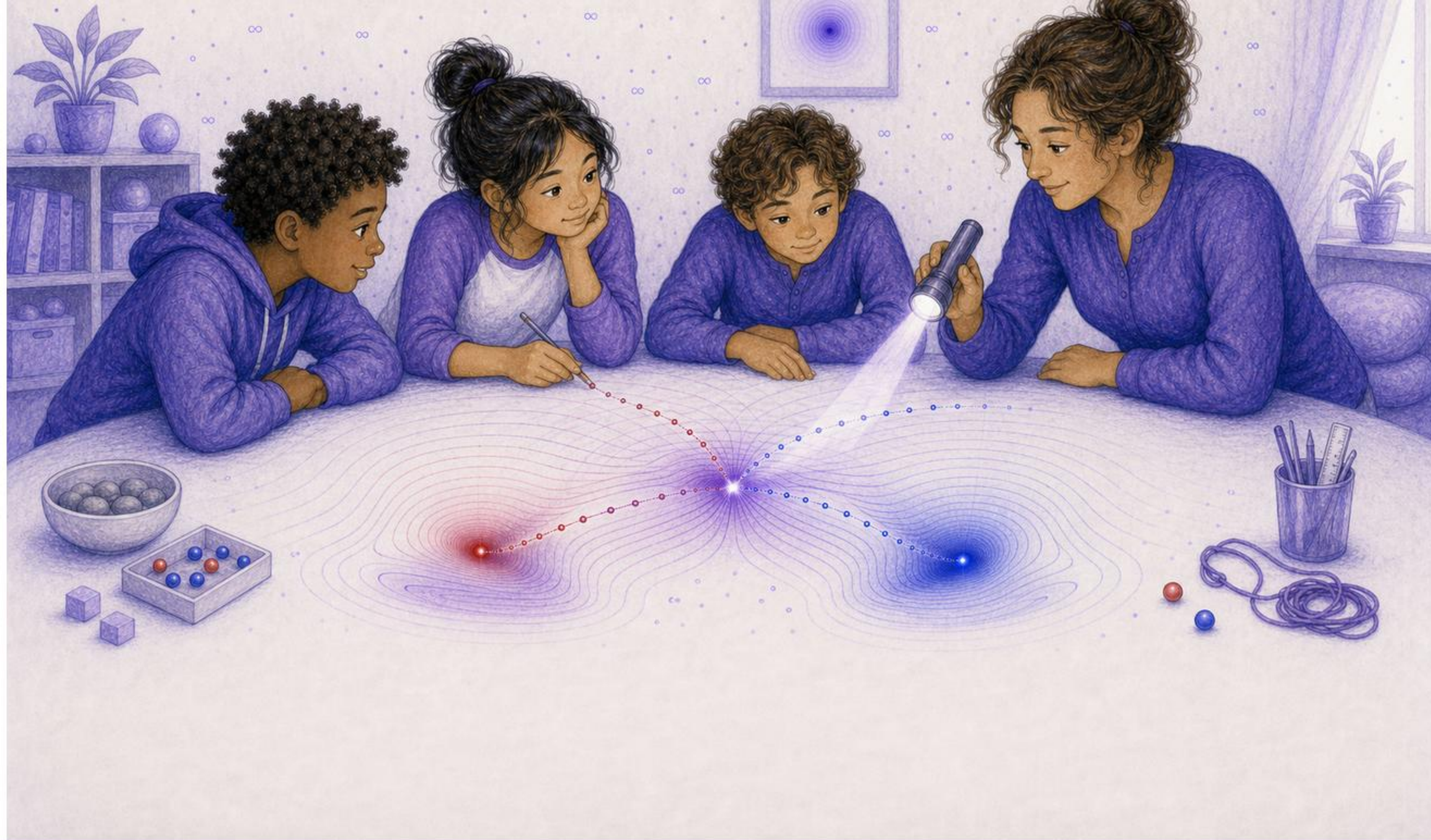
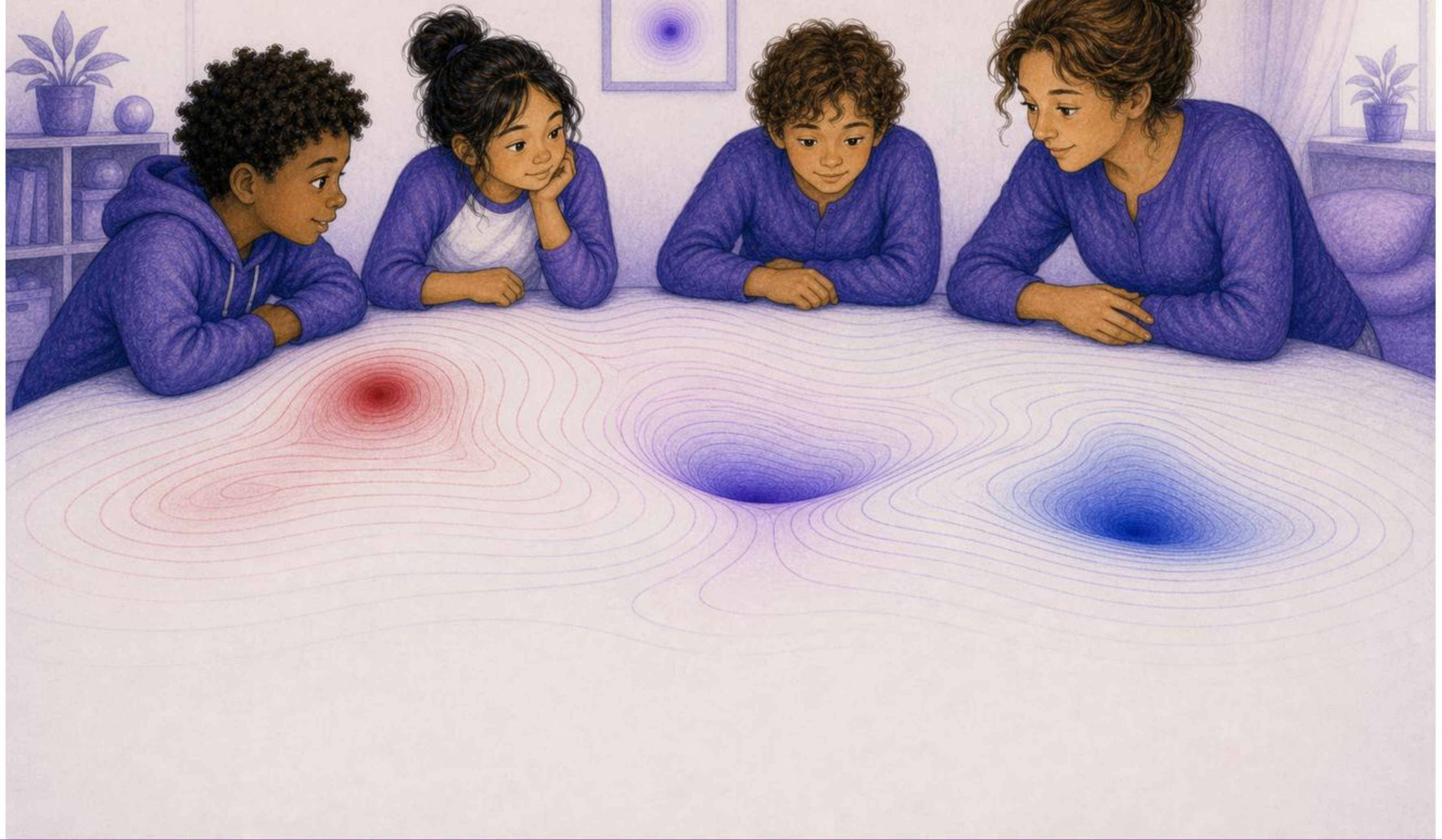




The Balance Point



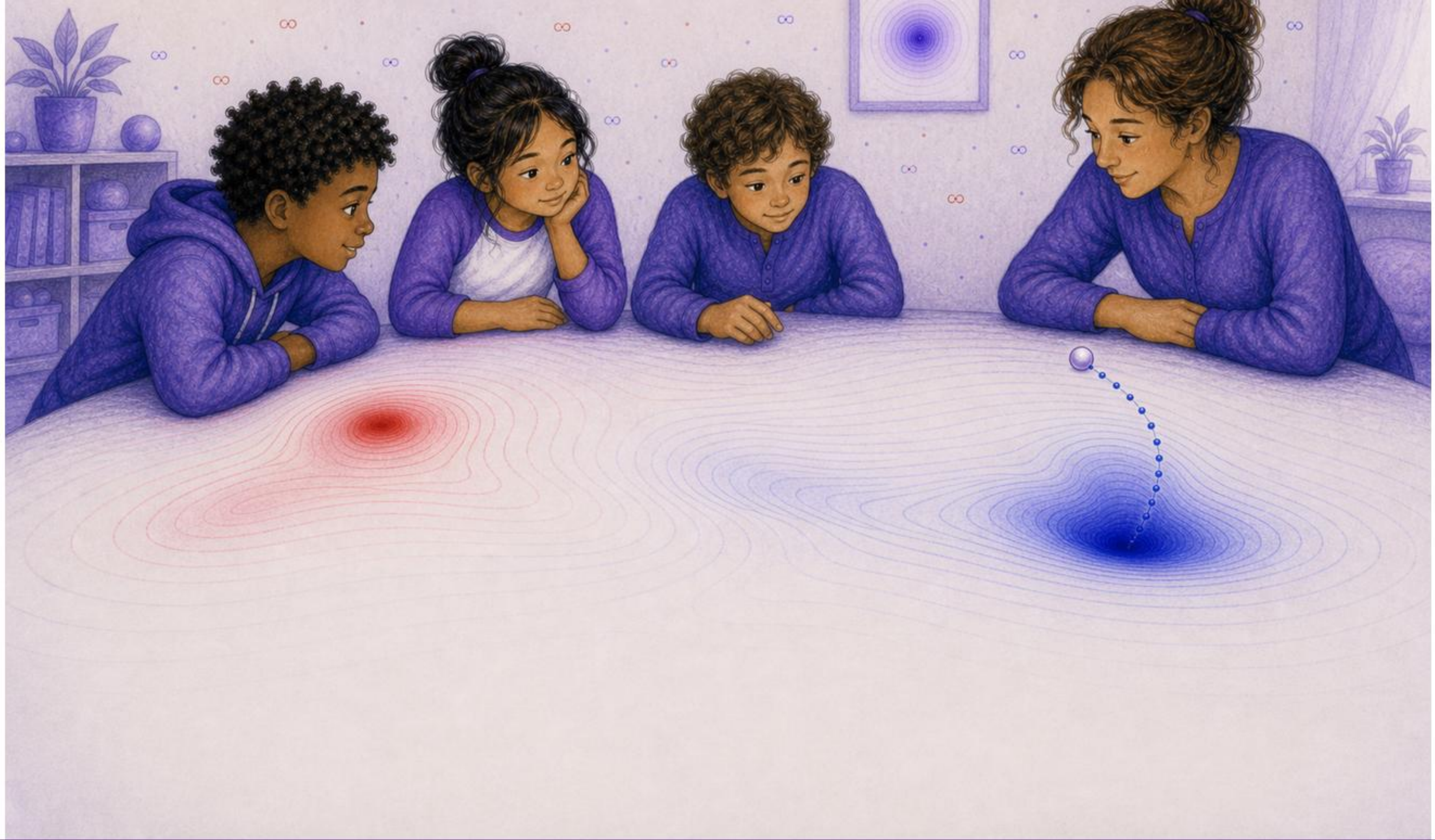
Dr. Sol tilted the table a little.
The bead did not ask where to go.
It followed the slope.



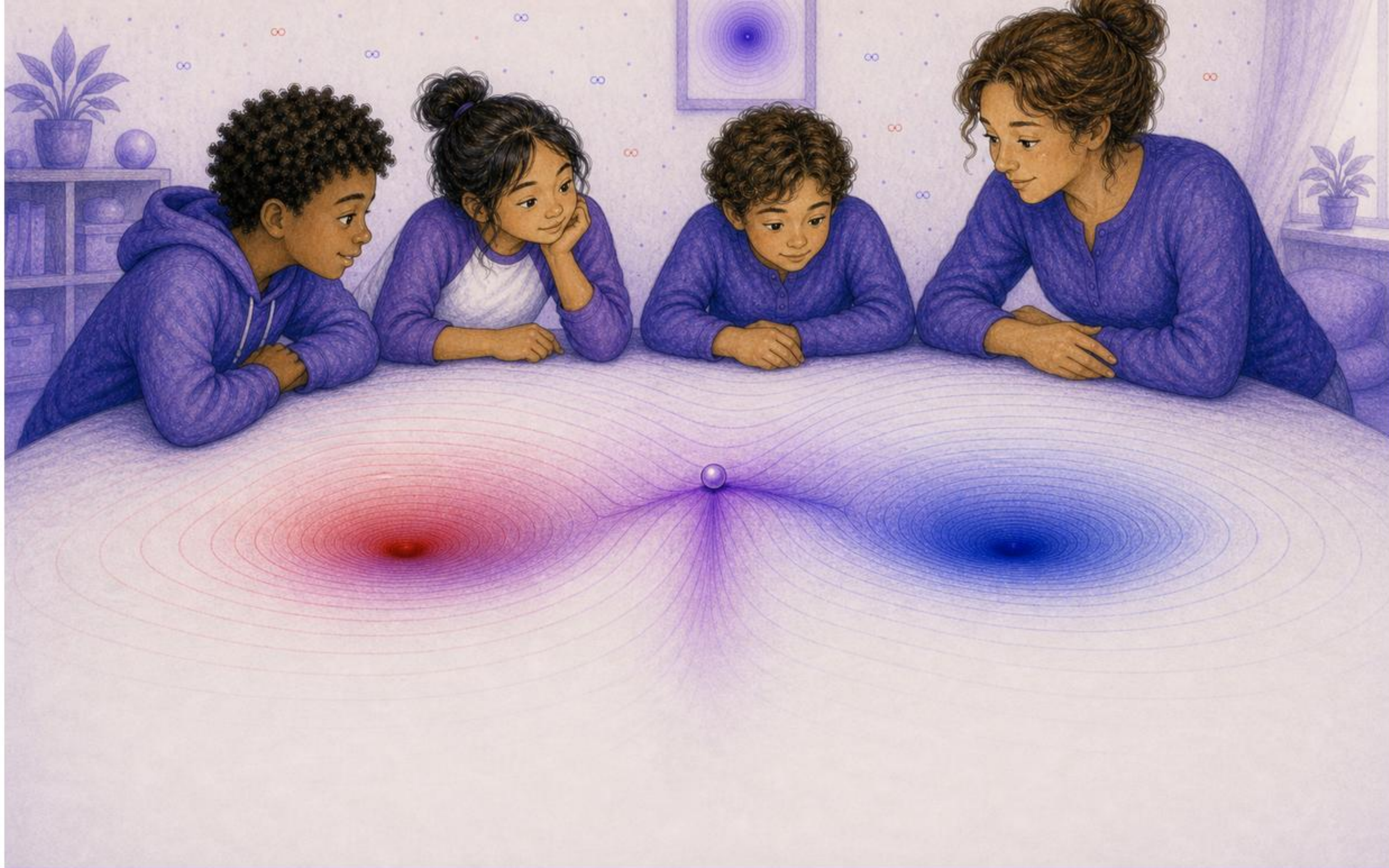
The table had high places.
It had low places.
The path could feel both.



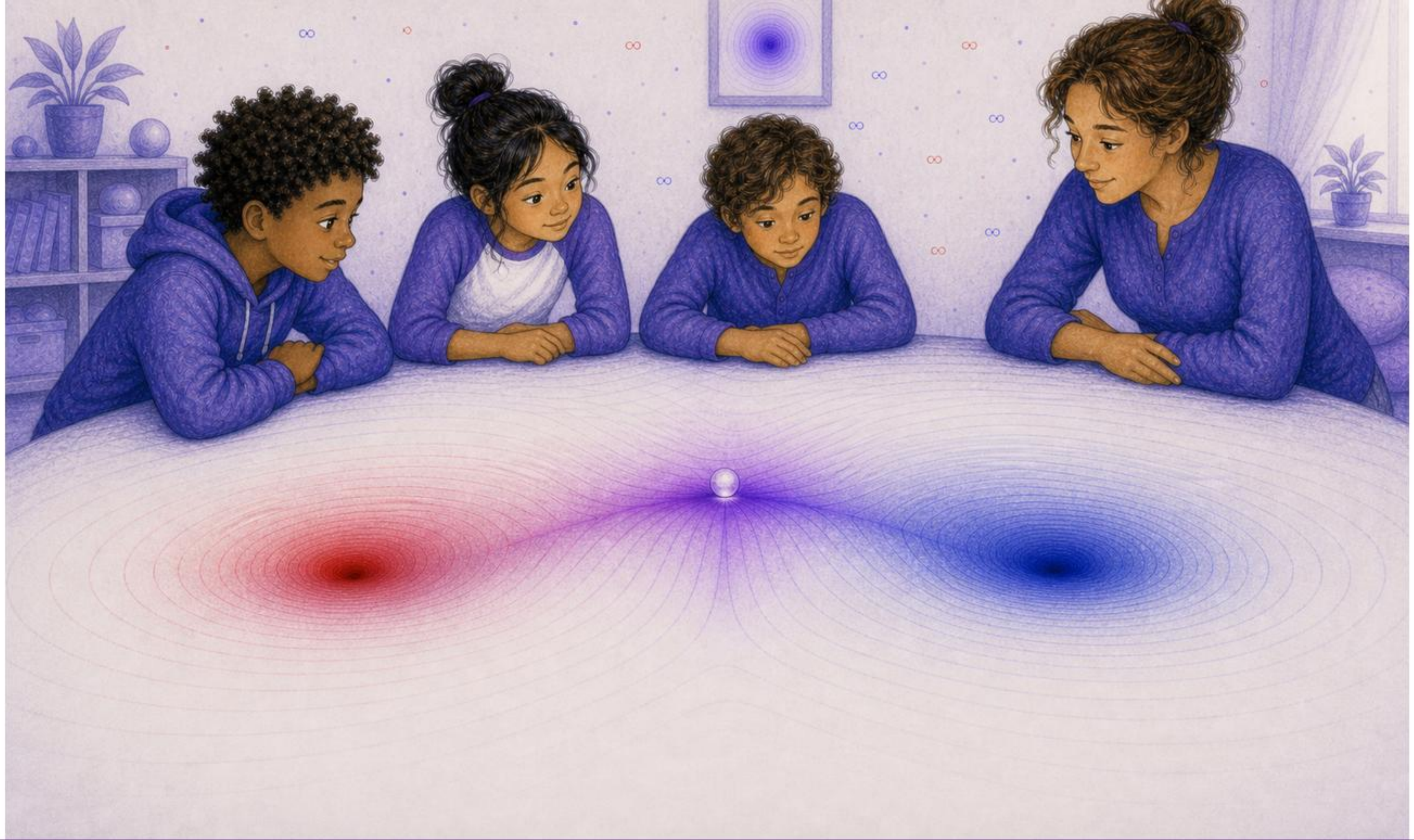
Mira released the bead.
It circled, slowed, and settled.



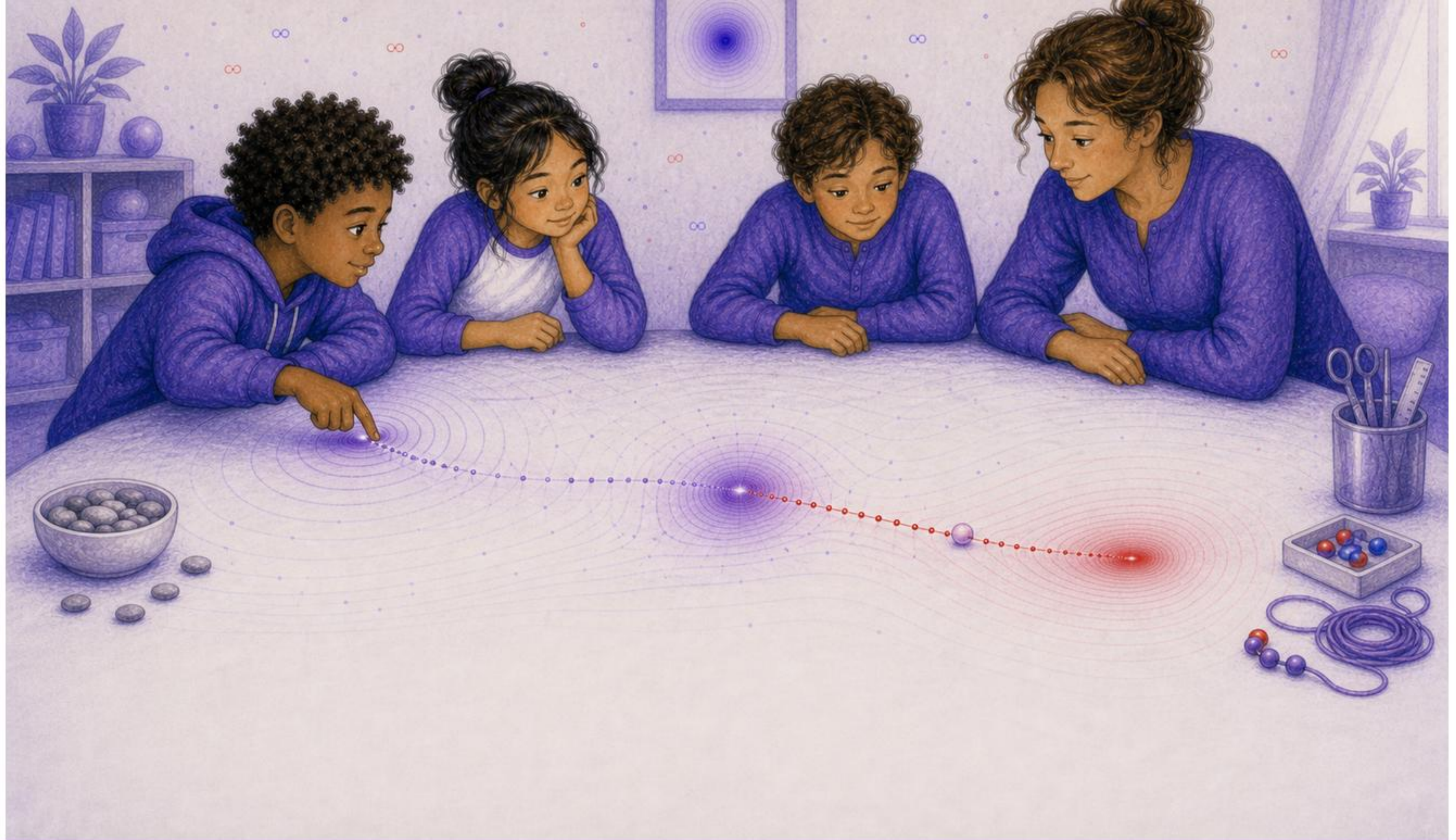
Tomas tried another place.
The bead settled somewhere else.



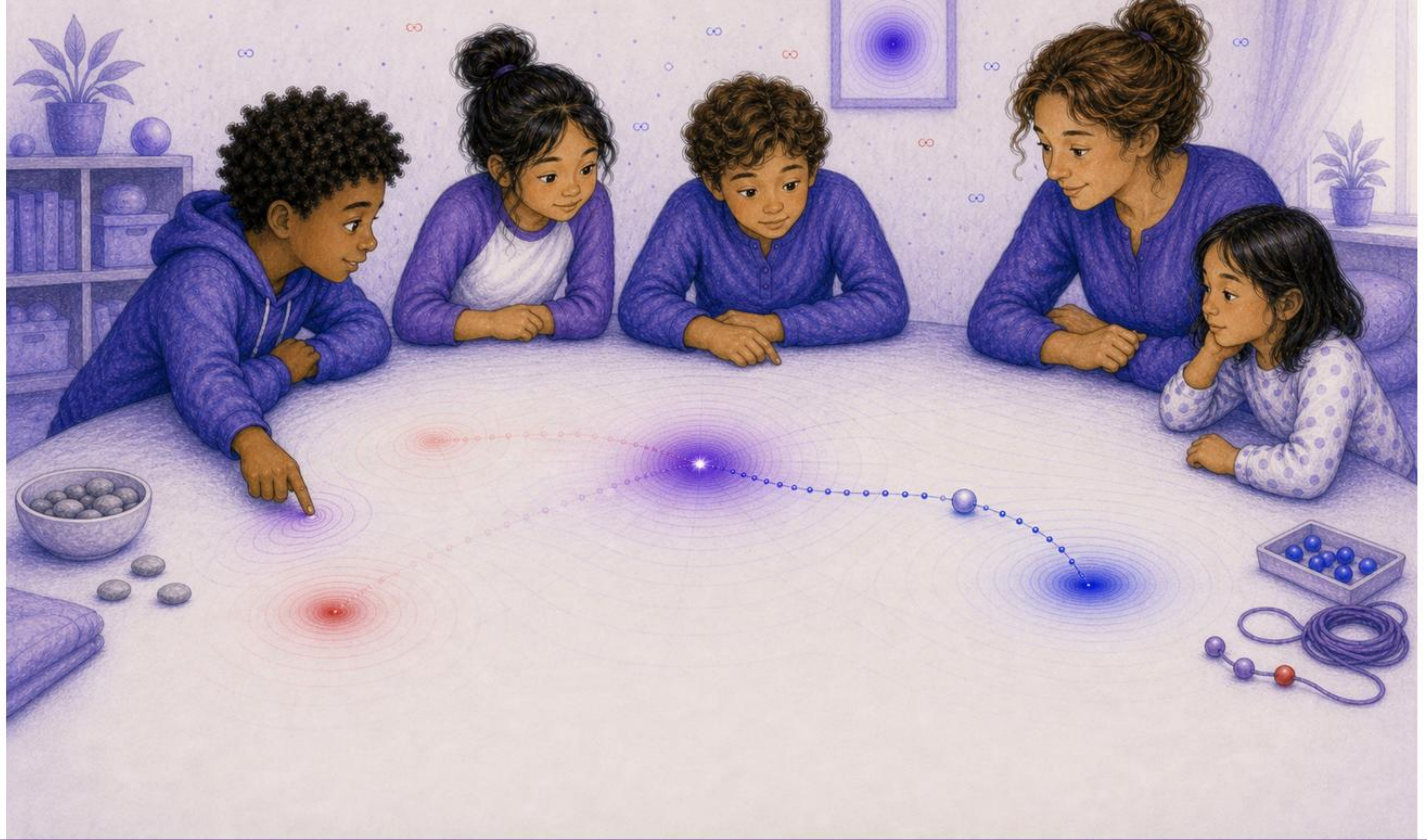
Between the basins was a ridge.
On the ridge, small things mattered.



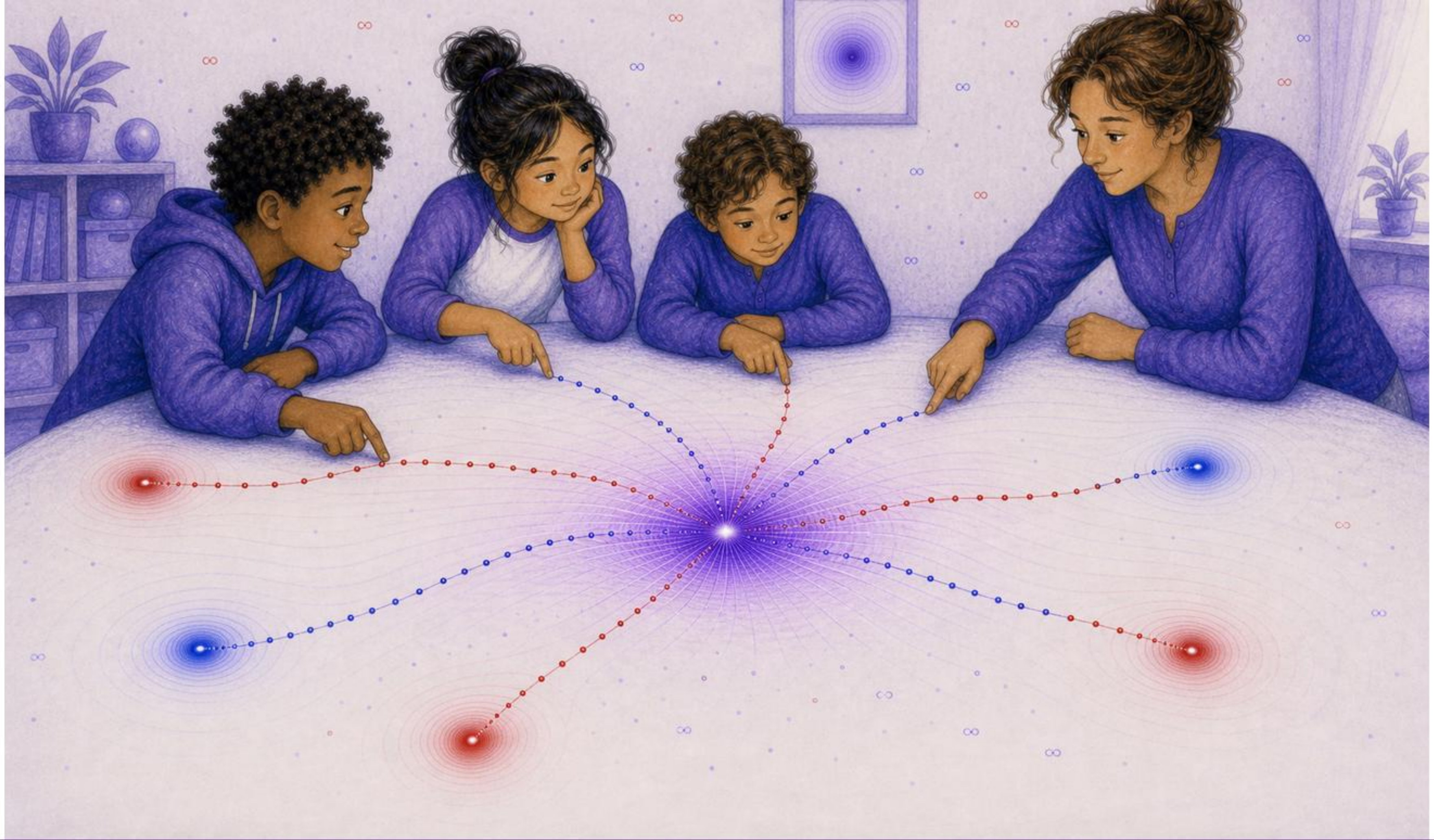
Ari placed the bead at the middle.
It waited on the balance point.



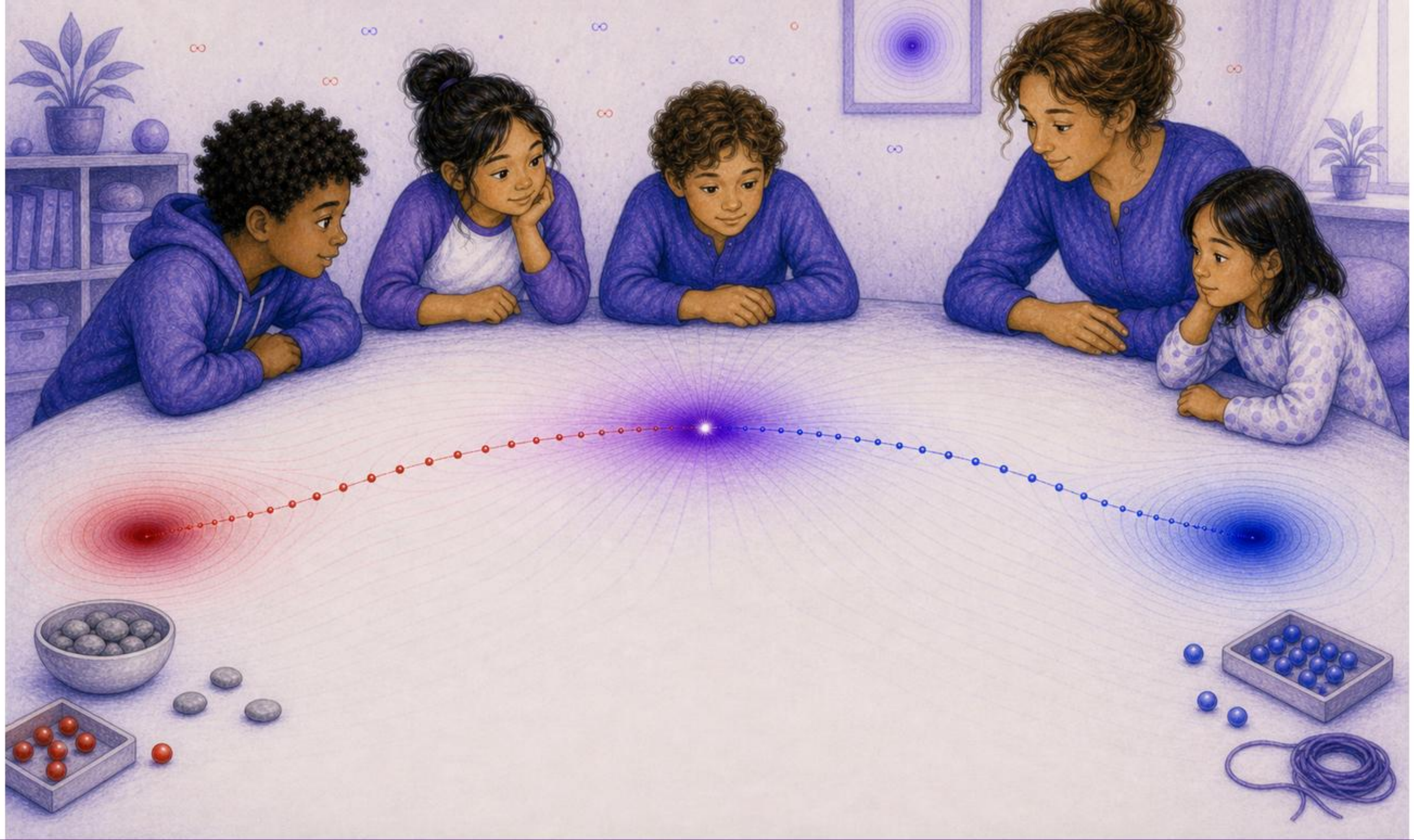
Mira touched the table.
Barely.
The bead began to move.



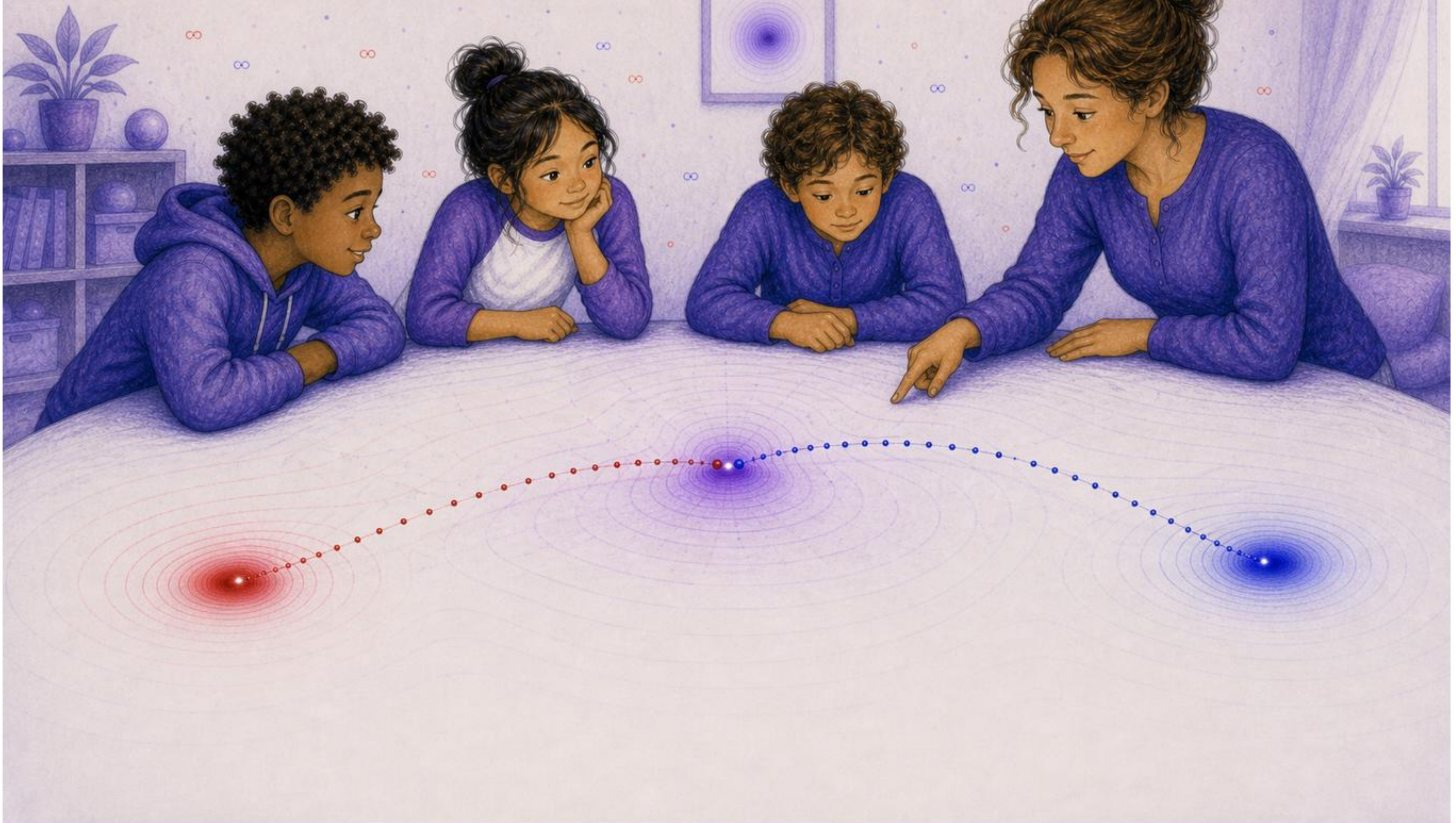
Tomas tried the same setup.
His tiny nudge sent the bead the other way.



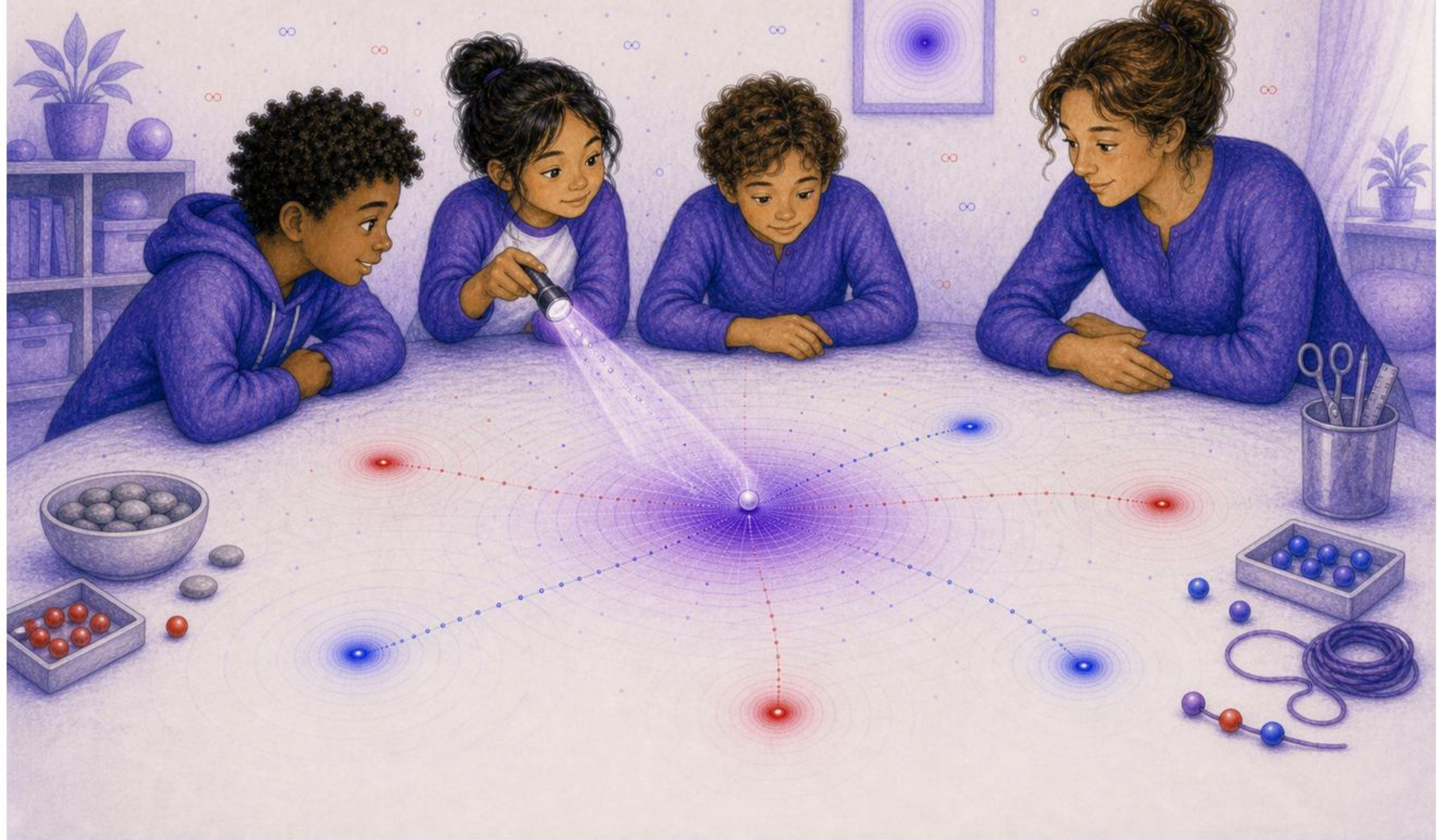
Before the balance point, the paths converged.
They bent toward one narrow place.



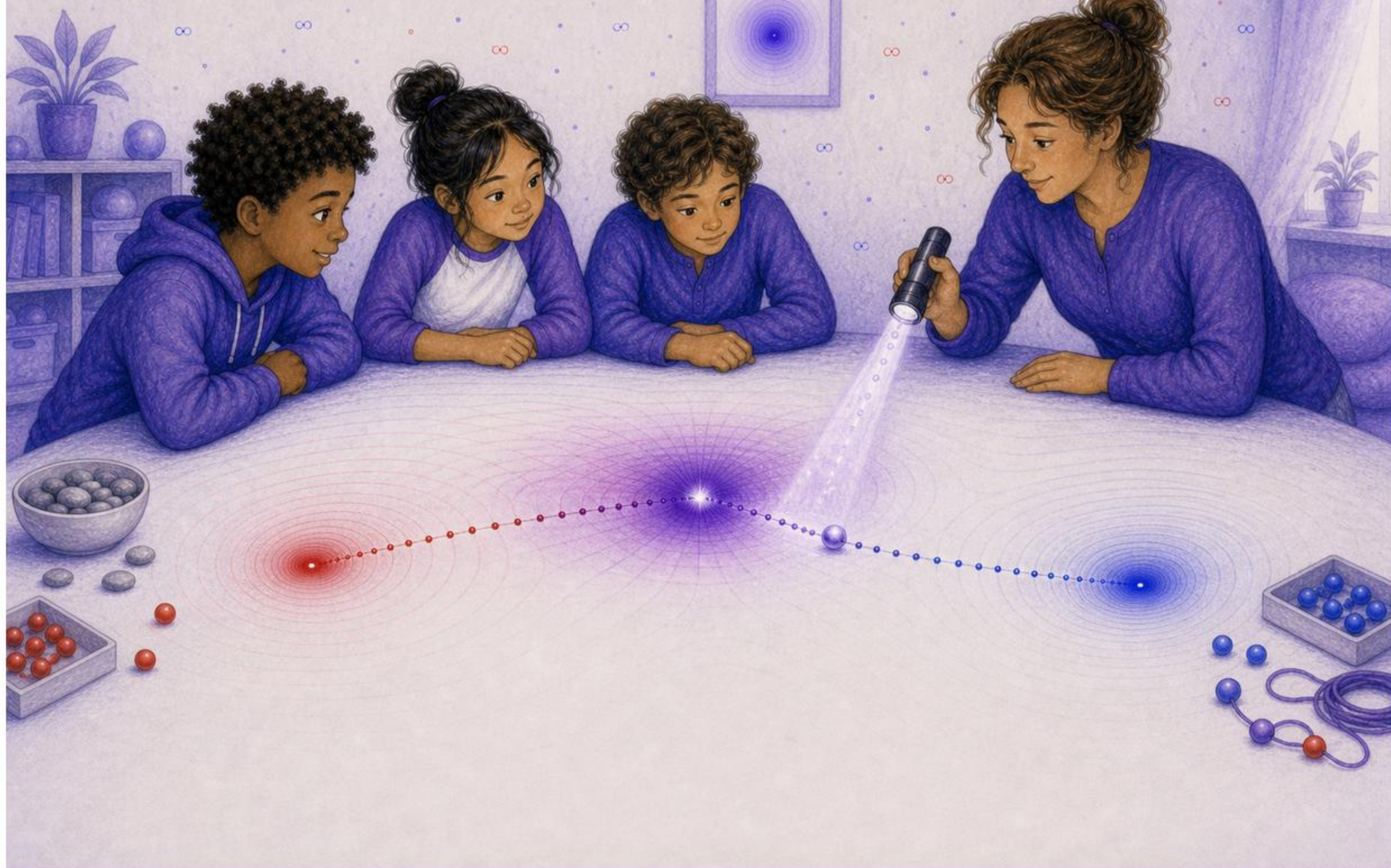
After the balance point, the paths diverged.
They widened into different basins.



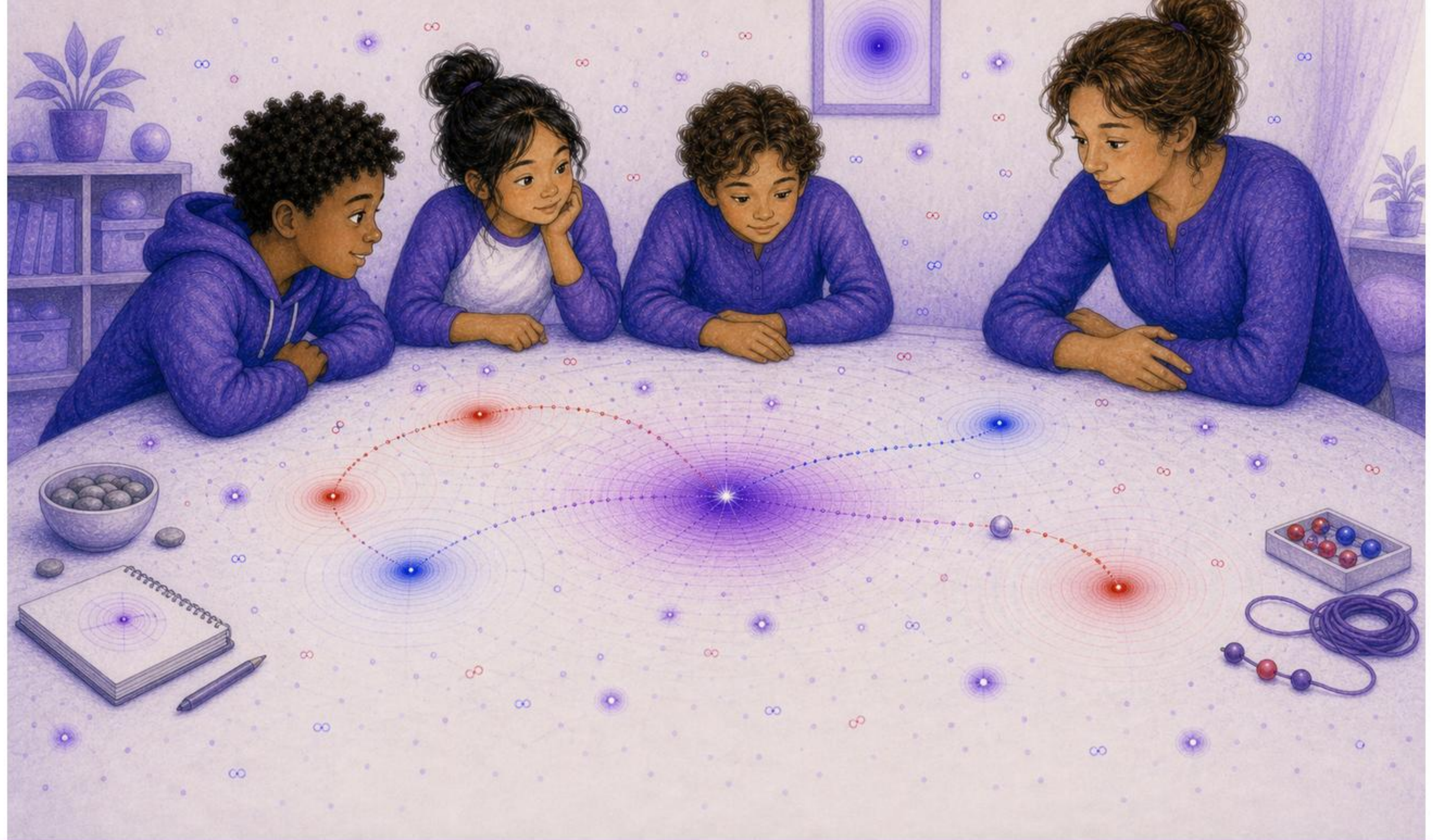
"Was it random?" Ari asked.
Dr. Sol shook her head.
"The rule was sensitive."



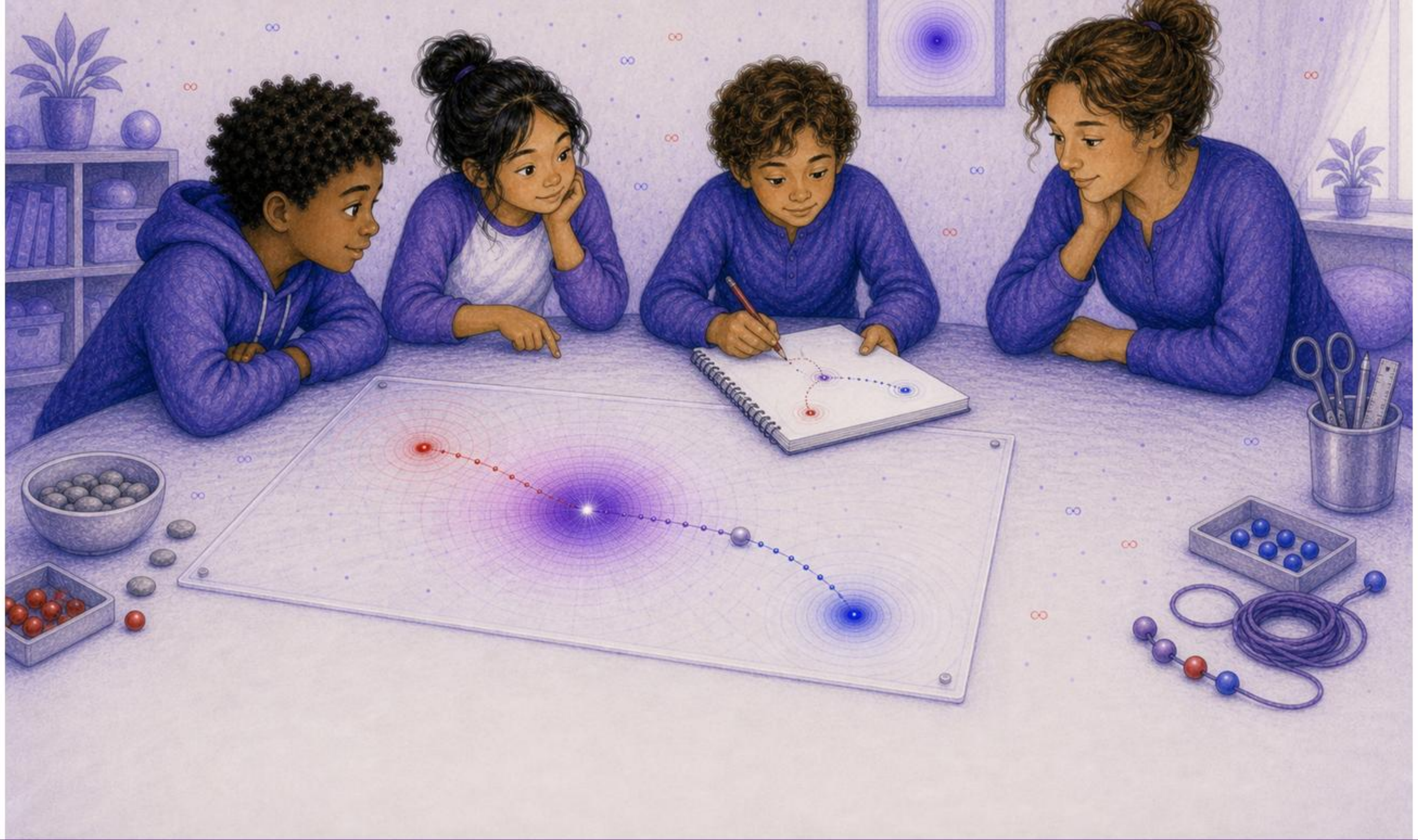
Mira shone a small light.
Looking was not nothing.



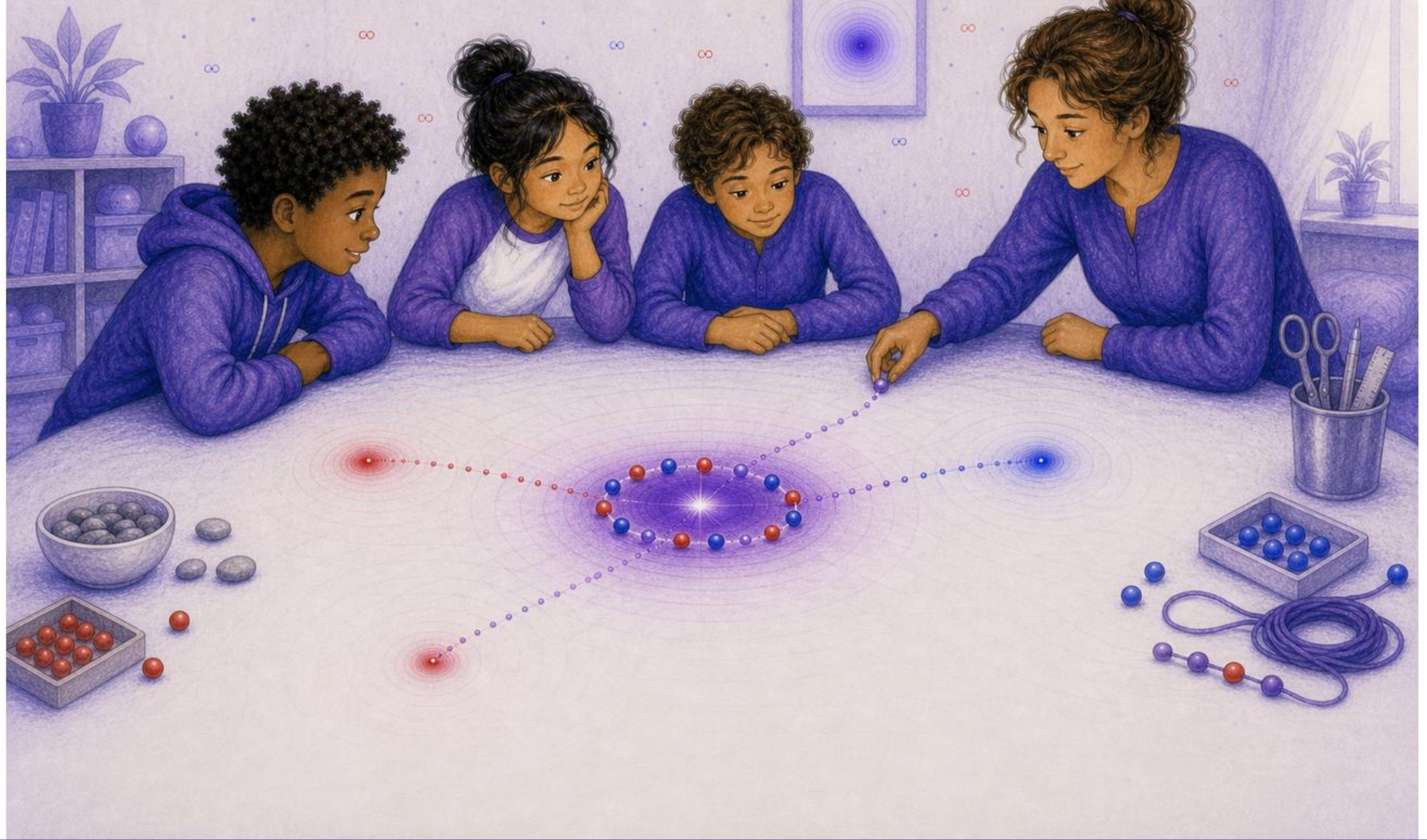
The light made a tiny mark.
The tiny mark changed the next step.



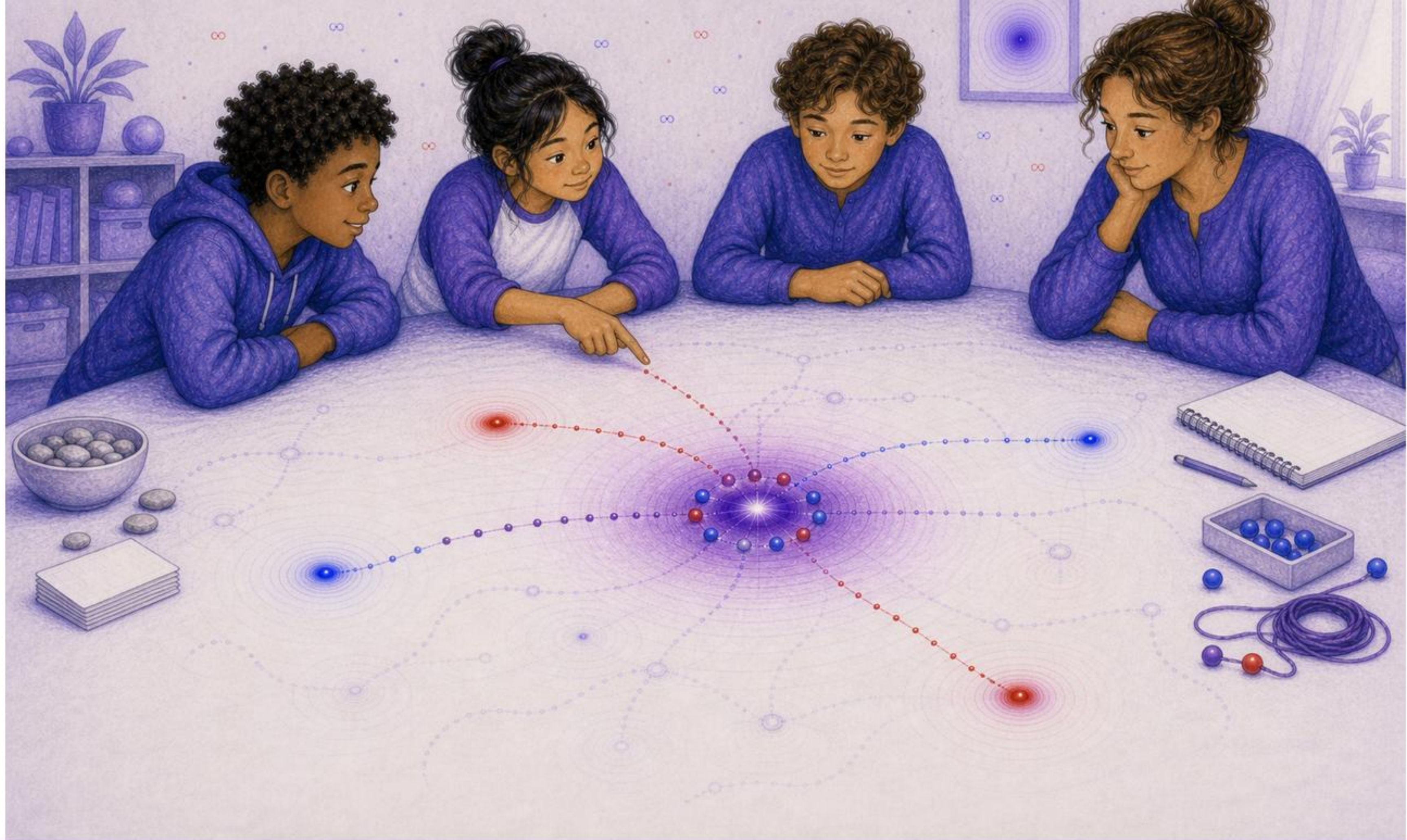
Around the table, tiny quiet patterns waited.
The bead was not moving in nothing.



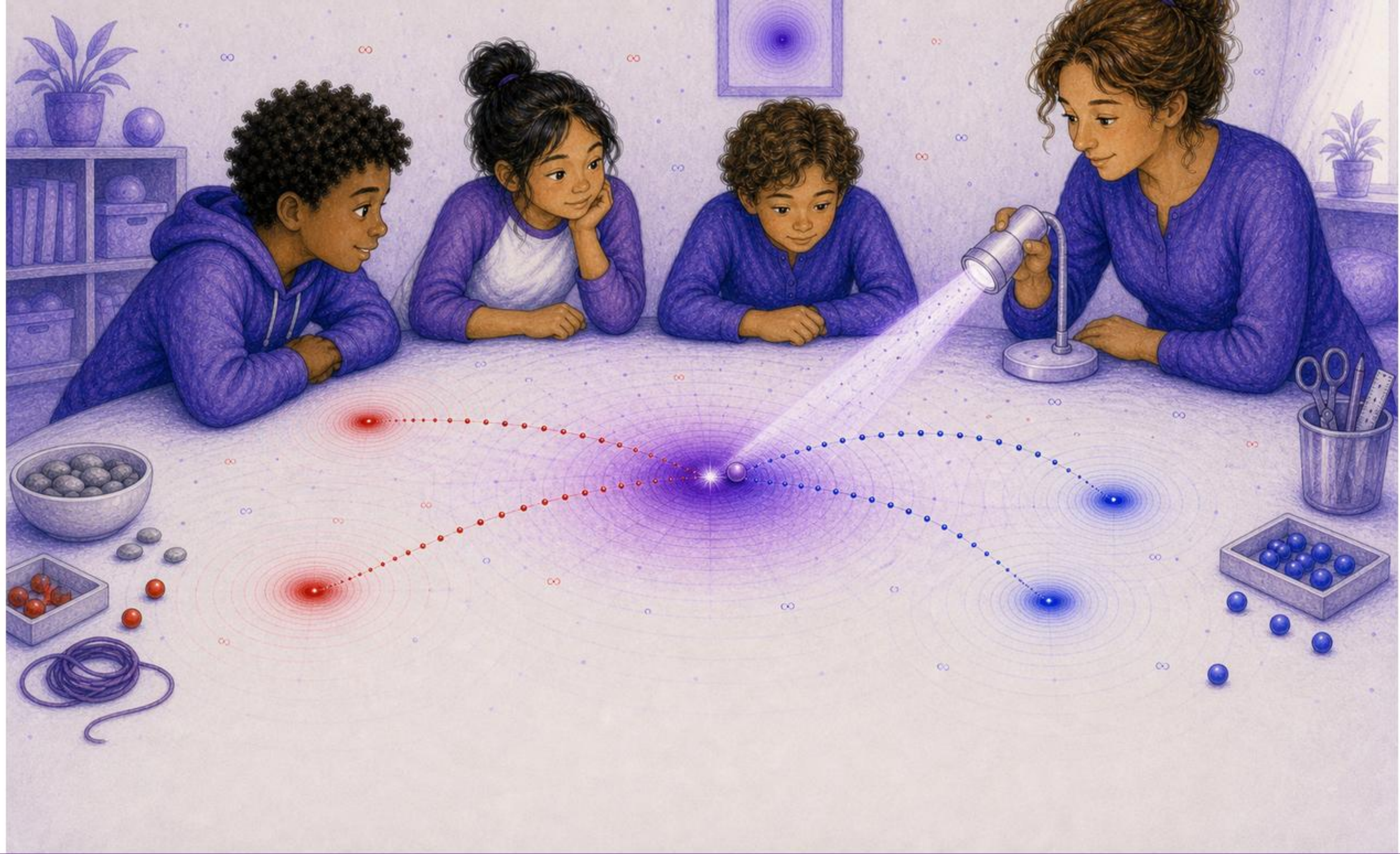
Tomas drew the paths afterward.
The drawing helped.
It was not the moving bead.



They reset the bead.
The rule stayed.
The path changed.



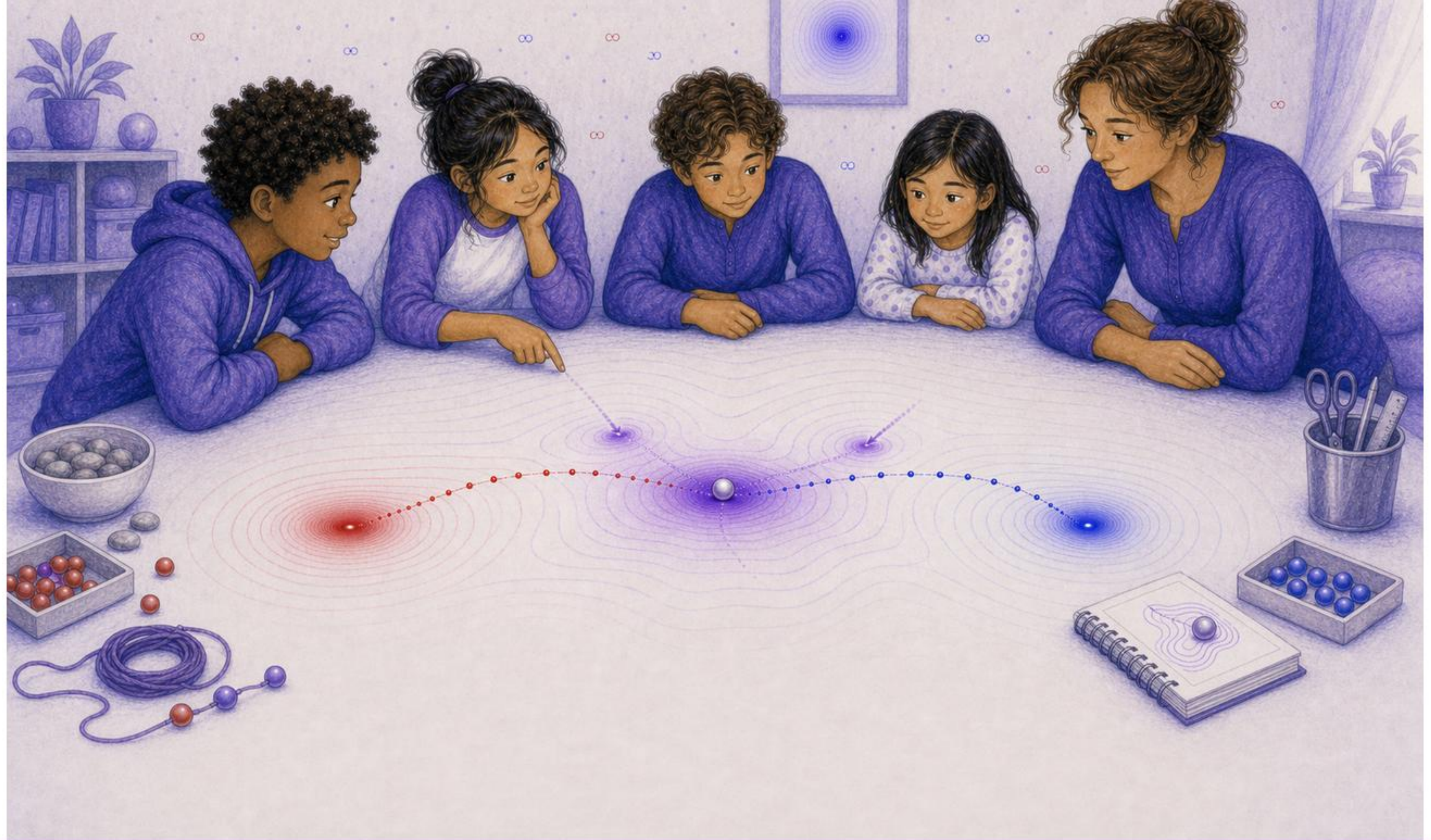
"We know the setup," Mira said.
"We know the paths we saw."
"We still have more to prove."



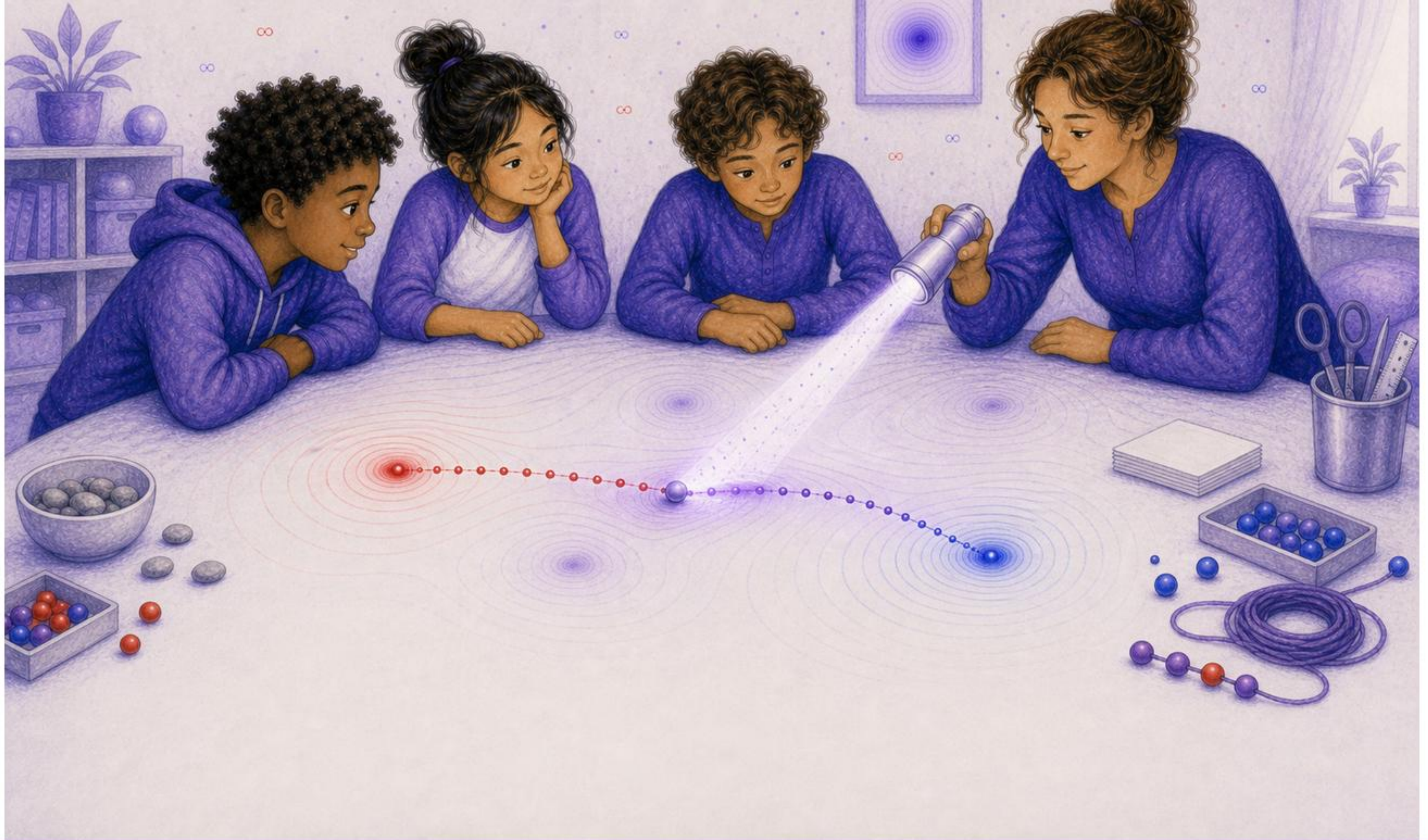
One tiny nudge could choose a path.
The rule was still there.



A path can move through a potential landscape.



Small nudges near thresholds can choose among lawful outcomes.



Measurement is a physical interaction.



Roll a bead into shallow bowls drawn on paper.